VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 22 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

A 9.1% drop as the first lock-up opens

SPCX fell 9.14% to $144.75 on Thursday, on 195 million shares, about twice its 30-session average, giving back all of Wednesday's 7.79% gain and more. The slide "followed profit-taking and a share unlock," The Motley Fool wrote; under the prospectus, up to 1.3 billion locked-up Class A shares could be sold from Thursday, with up to 328.4 million more from Saturday. The Nasdaq 100 lost 2.90% and the S&P 500 1.21%.

After the close, SpaceX filed its third-quarter 10-Q, which puts the Tesla talks in writing: "our board of directors has formed a special committee to evaluate a potential combination between SpaceX and Tesla, Inc.," and "No determination by our special committee has been made." Starlink 15-15, scrubbed a third straight day on Thursday, tries again this evening.

TODAY · NASA

Artemis update at 2 p.m.

Fri Oct 23 · 2:00 p.m. EDT · NASA media teleconference

NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman and other agency leaders will discuss the status of upcoming Moon missions and efforts to accelerate the Artemis campaign, according to a NASA advisory. NASA Artemis announced the briefing on X Thursday.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Starlink 15-15 scrubs in the final minute

A third straight stand-down at Vandenberg, this time after fueling; the next try is Friday evening.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Starlink 15-15 flies from the same pad.

PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

"Range weather went red," NASASpaceflight posted at 6:52 p.m. EDT Thursday. "This time, teams got through the fueling process and called off a launch attempt in the final minute. The scrub was called today due to poor weather at the launch pad," Spaceflight Now wrote four minutes later. At 7:21 p.m. SpaceX posted: "Due to unfavorable weather, we are standing down from today's @Starlink launch. Next opportunity is no earlier than Friday, October 23."

The attempts on Tuesday (technical issue) and Wednesday (weather) also ended in scrubs. The Falcon 9 carries 27 Starlink V2 Mini satellites on booster B1063's 36th flight, with a landing planned on the drone ship Of Course I Still Love You. Friday's window opens at 5:30 p.m. EDT, according to Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2 lists 6:28:53 p.m. with a "Go" status.

QUICK HIT

Booster home. Falcon 9 booster B1085, on its 19th flight, returned to Port Canaveral on Thursday, NASASpaceflight posted. Launch Library 2 lists no other Florida Falcon flight until Cygnus NG-25, targeted for late November.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

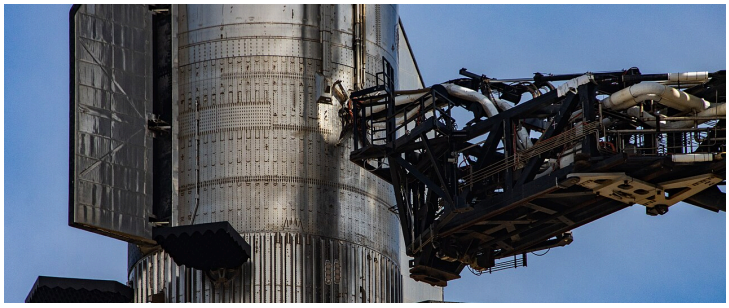
Starship Flight 15 now "mid-November"

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern: EDT through November 1, EST after.

DATE / TIME (EDT/EST)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Fri Oct 23, window opens 5:30 p.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1063, 36th flight. Scrubbed Oct 20 (technical issue), Oct 21 and Oct 22 (weather)	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2 (6:28 p.m.); SpaceX: NET Oct 23
Mon Oct 26, 1:00 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Thu Oct 29, 12:17 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-18	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Thu Nov 5, 12:14 a.m. EST	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-21. Moved earlier from NET Nov 10	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Thu Nov 5, 5:34 p.m. EST	Falcon 9	NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Mid-November	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; booster and ship catches planned. Previously NET Nov 8; no reason given	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial); SpaceX: "next month"
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
December	Starship	Flight 16, Ship 43 and Booster 23	LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) date or month, or an unofficial target. Changes since Thursday's issue: Starlink 15-15 slipped a third day after a weather scrub; Starlink 15-21 moved earlier to November 5 in Launch Library 2; Starship Flight 15 moved from an unofficial November 8 to "mid-November," with no reason given. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

Starship: two flows at once



The tower's quick-disconnect arm, which loads propellant, attached to a stacked Starship at Starbase, Texas, in April 2023.

PHOTO: JENNY HAUTMANN, "SPACE X BOOSTER FULL STACK," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0

"SpaceX is working on dual flows for its upcoming Starship missions, with Flight 15 set for mid-November from Pad 2. This is ahead of Flight 16's vehicles, which are expected to head to KSC for a launch from 39A," NASASpaceflight posted at 11:08 p.m. EDT Thursday. Flight 16 would be Starship's first launch from Florida, with Ship 43 and Booster 23 (NASASpaceflight).

At Starbase, the site "should be seeing road closures for Booster 22 to the pad and Static Fire testing soon," NASASpaceflight posted Thursday morning. That evening, a reposted update reported a deluge test at Pad 2 "following a couple hours of BQD and holddown" activity, as testing of Ship 39 continued at the Massey's site. Neither SpaceX nor the FAA has announced a launch date.

III · STARLINK

Looking for 80,000 cell sites

SpaceX is in talks with tower owners for a ground network for Starlink Mobile.

SpaceX is seeking access to at least 80,000 U.S. cell sites for a wireless network and is in talks with Crown Castle, Bloomberg News reported Thursday, in deals that could reach into the billions of dollars. "You can assume that we're talking to all parties," Crown Castle's chief executive said; American Tower declined to comment (Reuters). On Tuesday's earnings call, Musk said the effort "will pave the way for Starlink Mobile to become a major mobile carrier in the US," Bloomberg noted.

The 10-Q counts 13.6 million Starlink consumer subscribers at September 30, up from 7.2 million a year earlier. Third-quarter revenue rose 69.5%, driven by 88.9% subscriber growth and a 16.9% drop in consumer revenue per user "as we expanded internationally and added lower-priced service plans," along with more aircraft activations.

QUICK HIT

Spending. SpaceX spent $48.07 billion on property, plant and equipment in the first nine months, against $13.85 billion a year earlier, and ended September with $51.29 billion in cash plus $38.56 billion in marketable securities, the 10-Q shows.

IV · THE MOON

"Way too high": 22 refuelings vs. 6 to 8

A NASA safety panel heard a new estimate for Starship's lunar landing; Musk disputed it.

The latest estimate for refuelings needed to support a Starship landing on the Moon is "around 22" launches, member Charlie Precourt said at Thursday's meeting of NASA's Aerospace Safety Advisory Panel, Ars Technica's Eric Berger posted at 2:43 p.m. EDT. "That's way too high. Actual number will be more like 6 to 8," Musk replied at 5:12 p.m. (Ars Technica). The panel also discussed concerns about Artemis IV and future access to low Earth orbit, SpacePolicyOnline reported.

Boeing's Starliner-1 mission is no earlier than mid-January, the panel said, Jeff Foust posted. If the space station's life is extended from 2030 to 2032, the U.S. Deorbit Vehicle, a modified Dragon, "would launch on a non-Falcon rocket," Berger posted.

V · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

A 10-Q and an S-8

Two SEC filings Thursday afternoon; no new FAA Federal Register notices or FCC actions.

SEC

10-Q · Oct 22, 4:03 p.m. EDT — Quarterly report for the period ended Sep 30; discloses the special committee on Tesla; 8,246,541,218 Class A and 5,334,522,491 Class B shares as of Oct 15; $5 billion available under its credit facility and $250 million under an xAI credit line. Filing

S-8 · Oct 22, 4:24 p.m. EDT — Registers about 71.1 million Class A shares for options and restricted stock units assumed in the August 14 acquisition of Cursor maker Anysphere, plus 23.6 million shares for resale by holders. Filing

FAA

Open · Starbase PEIS — Comments on the FAA's Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement for more Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808) are due November 30. Federal Register

FCC

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Nov 4 · Surety bond — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

Takeaways

1. SPCX fell 9.14% to $144.75 as the first lock-up tranche opened.
2. The 10-Q confirms a special committee on a Tesla combination.
3. Starlink 15-15 scrubbed a third time; it tries again tonight.
4. SpaceX is seeking access to 80,000 U.S. cell sites.
5. Musk says a Moon landing needs 6 to 8 refuelings, not 22.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceX, @SpaceflightNow, @NASASpaceflight, @SciGuySpace, @jeff_foust, @NASAArtemis and @elonmusk on X; Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight, NASA, Federal Register; Bloomberg (via Yahoo Finance), Reuters (via Investing.com), The Motley Fool, Ars Technica, SpacePolicyOnline, Broadband Breakfast, Exterra; SEC EDGAR and prospectus; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Wikimedia Commons (Jenny Hautmann, CC BY-SA 4.0).

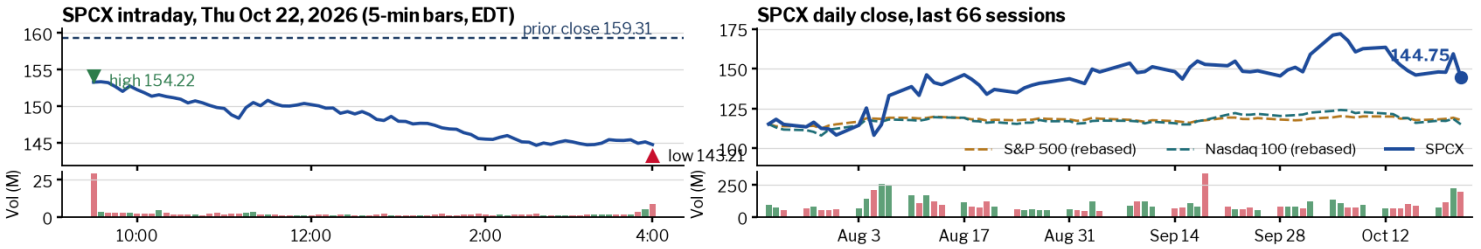
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Down 9.1% as the lock-up opens

The Nasdaq Composite fell 2.60% and the S&P 500 1.21%; Rocket Lab lost 4.56%, The Motley Fool reported.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$144.75	−$14.56	$154.21	$154.26	$143.21
Thu Oct 22, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−9.14% vs $159.31*	*regular session*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*	*3:55 p.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
195.39M	$105–$226	$1.97T	−2.6% / −2.4%	+7.2%
+100.7% vs 30-session avg 97.35M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.58B Class A+B shares (Oct 15) × close*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; −10.07% vs first close*

SINCE IPO — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $144.75 | high $225.64 · Jun 16; 50-day avg $149.12



As of close Oct 22, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 22 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−9.14%**	**−2.60%**	**−2.43%**	**−10.07%**
S&P 500	−1.21%	−1.04%	−0.55%	+3.12%
Nasdaq 100	−2.90%	−3.26%	−4.96%	−2.29%
RKLB	−4.56%	−7.29%	−27.15%	−49.98%
ASTS	−5.21%	−12.80%	−35.36%	−52.95%
IRDM	−1.04%	−2.67%	−9.34%	−7.46%

OPTIONS (CBOE, THU OCT 22 CLOSE)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 23	255,115	220,523	0.86	79.0%	$170 / $140
Oct 26	41,652	44,333	1.06	55.6%	$160 / $140
Oct 28	17,809	20,076	1.13	59.1%	$160 / $160
Oct 30	166,271	137,168	0.82	58.8%	$190 / $150
All expiries	**2,454,828**	**2,493,367**	**1.02**		**30-day IV index 54.3**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 23

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (34 analysts)	$257.71 (+78.0%)
Median target	$242.50
High / low target	$800.00 / $70.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.65%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.57%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 22 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.00)	—
Forward P/E (est. $2.50)	57.9
Price/sales (rev. $32.04B)	61.4
Beta	—
50-day average	$149.12 (−2.9%)
200-day average	—
Q4 EPS est. (20 analysts)	$0.41
Q4 revenue est. (22)	$22.76B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 22	Bank of America	Buy	$235 to $275
Oct 22	Pivotal Research	Buy	$230 to $260
Oct 21	JPMorgan	Overweight	$240 to $500
Oct 21	Barclays	Overweight	$254 to $300
Oct 21	Citigroup	Buy	$200 to $240
Oct 21	UBS	Buy	$210 to $230
Oct 21	Macquarie	Outperform	$250

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 23	**NASA Artemis update, 2 p.m. EDT; Starlink 15-15**
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more shares
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Mid-Nov	Starship Flight 15 (unofficial target)
Mon Nov 30	FAA Starbase PEIS scoping comments due
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 22). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 23, 8:41 a.m. EDT. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. Dashes: not yet meaningful (negative EPS; listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) after Wednesday's close and IV at Thursday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $145 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (8,246,541,218 Class A + 5,334,522,491 Class B, Oct 15). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4). FCC dates: Exterra, Broadband Breakfast.